

World War II

In 1939, a war broke out in Europe that spread across the world. Bombs were dropped on cities by planes, and millions of soldiers were killed in battle. Both Germany, led by Adolf Hitler and the Nazi Party, and Japan conquered huge empires. They were defeated in 1945 by a group of countries called the Allies.



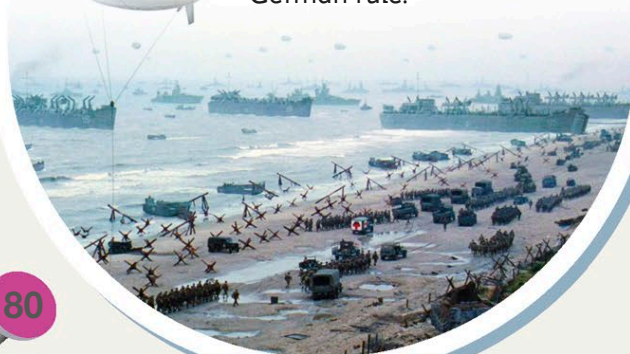
German refugee children in 1938

Children at war

Anti-Jewish laws forced Jewish children in Germany to escape to other countries, becoming refugees. Other children left their homes in cities to escape bombing.

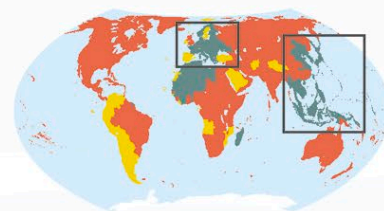
D-day

The largest ever invasion from the sea took place on June 6, 1944. American, British, and Canadian troops crossed the English Channel and landed on the French coast to free France from German rule.



Europe and the Far East

The fighting mainly took place in Europe and the Far East, although many other parts of the world were also involved.



Jews in Germany were forced to wear yellow stars bearing the word "Jude"—German for Jew.



The Holocaust

The Nazis killed Jewish people just because they were Jewish. During the Holocaust, Jews were sent to camps to be killed. More than six million died.

El Alamein, Egypt, 1942